LARKSPUR & CO.

A GENTLE 28-DAY PROGRAMME

The 28-Day Task Paralysis Reset

For the days you know exactly what to do but can't make yourself start. One small page a day, one new tool at a time.

ADHD-friendly | Undated | Print at home | 50 pages



Miss a day? Just carry on from the next page. There's nothing to catch up on.

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START HERE

Welcome. You're not lazy.

If you've ever sat staring at a task you *want* to do, feeling completely stuck, this is for you. Task paralysis is common, especially for people with ADHD, and it isn't a character flaw. It's a problem with starting, and starting is a skill you can practise.

HOW THE 28 DAYS WORK

1. Each day has **one page** and **one tool** to try. It takes about five minutes.
2. Use the tool on **one real task** from your life, however small.
3. Every seven days, a **review page** helps you notice what's working.
4. At the end, you build your own **Unstuck Plan** to keep.

THE RULES

- [ ] It's undated, so start any day.
- [ ] Missed a day? Turn to the next page. No catching up.
- [ ] Did the page but not the task? That still counts.
- [ ] Trying a tool and hating it is useful information.
- [ ] Be as kind to yourself as you would be to a friend.

THE FOUR WEEKS

Week 1: Shrink it	Big, vague tasks are the hardest to start. This week is about making tasks so small and clear that starting feels almost silly.
Week 2: Start it	Now the tasks are smaller, it's time for tools that get you over the starting line, especially on days when your brain just won't engage.
Week 3: Keep going	Starting is half the battle. This week is about keeping the momentum going and picking things back up when you drift.
Week 4: Make it yours	You've tried a lot of tools. This week you'll notice what works for your brain and build a plan you can keep using.

This programme is a self-help tool, not a diagnosis, treatment or medical advice. If you're struggling a lot, please talk to your GP or a health professional.

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UNDERSTANDING IT

What is task paralysis?

Task paralysis is when you can't get yourself to start (or carry on with) a task, even though you want to, you know it matters, and you might even know exactly how to do it.

It often comes with a lot of noise: guilt, frustration, scrolling your phone while the task sits there, and an inner voice calling you lazy. You're not lazy. Starting a task relies on a group of brain skills often called **executive function**: planning, prioritising, getting going, switching between things and managing feelings about the task. Many people with ADHD find these skills harder to use on demand, especially for tasks that are boring, unclear or emotionally loaded.

It's not about effort

Trying harder rarely works. Changing the task, the setting or the timing usually does.

It's not about caring

People often freeze most on the things they care about most.

It can change

Small tools, used often, make starting easier over time.

What helps, in a nutshell

- **Make it smaller**: tiny, clear, physical first steps.
- **Make it easier**: remove friction and set the scene.
- **Make it more interesting**: novelty, challenge, company or a reward.
- **Make it kinder**: lower the bar and drop the shame.

WHEN DOES IT HIT ME HARDEST?

GETTING STARTED

What kind of stuck?

Different kinds of stuck need different tools. Tick the ones that sound like you. You'll come back to this page on day 6.

- [ ] **Unclear**
  You don't really know what the first step is.
  Try: Next physical action (day 3), break it into crumbs (day 4)

- [ ] **Too big**
  It feels like a mountain, so you can't see where to begin.
  Try: Crumbs (day 4), the two-minute start (day 2), timer sprint (day 9)

- [ ] **Boring**
  Your brain finds nothing in it to grab onto.
  Try: Pair it (day 12), add interest (day 17), body doubling (day 10)

- [ ] **Scared of getting it wrong**
  Perfectionism, or worry about what people will think.
  Try: Lower the bar (day 5), make it ugly (day 11), kind self-talk (day 25)

- [ ] **Too many choices**
  Everything feels important, so you freeze choosing.
  Try: The one thing (day 1), tomorrow tonight (day 27)

- [ ] **Running on empty**
  You're tired, hungry, overwhelmed or unwell.
  Try: Match your energy (day 21), a gentle day (day 7). Rest is allowed.

MY MOST COMMON KIND OF STUCK

KEEP THIS HANDY

Stuck? Start here.

Follow the arrows when you're frozen. One box at a time.

Notice it. "I'm stuck." Saying it out loud takes some of the power away.

↓

Check your body. Hungry, thirsty, tired, too hot, too noisy? Fix the easiest one first.

↓

Name the block. Unclear? Too big? Boring? Scary? Too many choices? (page 5)

↓

Shrink it. What's the first physical action? Make it two minutes or less.

↓

Make it easier. Set the scene, add music, find a body double, lower the bar.

↓

Start the timer. Two to ten minutes. You can stop when it rings.

↓

Notice the win. Started? Write it on your done list. Still stuck? Rest and try again later.

You don't need motivation to start. Starting is what creates it.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

My starting point

A quick snapshot of where you are today. You'll look back at it on day 28.

RIGHT NOW, STARTING TASKS FEELS...

Easy ○ Sometimes hard ○ Usually hard ○ Almost impossible ○

TASKS I'VE BEEN AVOIDING

- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

TIMES I USUALLY GET STUCK

- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

THINGS I ALREADY KNOW HELP ME

WHAT I USUALLY SAY TO MYSELF WHEN I'M STUCK

IN 28 DAYS, I'D LOVE TO...

Start date _____ Signed _____

WEEK 1 OF 4

Shrink it

Big, vague tasks are the hardest to start. This week is about making tasks so small and clear that starting feels almost silly.

THIS WEEK'S TOOLS

- [ ] Day 1: The one thing
- [ ] Day 2: The two-minute start
- [ ] Day 3: The next physical action
- [ ] Day 4: Break it into crumbs
- [ ] Day 5: Lower the bar
- [ ] Day 6: Name the block
- [ ] Day 7: A gentle day

MY INTENTION FOR THIS WEEK

DAY
1

WEEK 1 · SHRINK IT
The one thing

Date _____

When everything feels urgent, your brain can freeze trying to choose. Today, you choose just one task. Everything else can wait until it's done or the day ends.

Try it today
Look at everything on your plate and circle the one task that would make today feel lighter. Write it below. That's today's whole job.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
2

WEEK 1 · SHRINK IT

The two-minute start

Date _____

Starting is often the hardest part. A tiny commitment gets past the "this is huge" feeling, and once you've started, carrying on is usually easier.

Try it today
Promise yourself just two minutes on your task. Set a timer. When it rings, you're allowed to stop. If you keep going, that's a bonus.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
3

WEEK 1 · SHRINK IT

The next physical action

Date _____

"Sort out the car insurance" isn't a step, it's a project. Your brain needs to know exactly what your hands do first.

Try it today
Rewrite your task as a physical action that starts with a verb: "open the laptop", "find the letter", "type the website in". Do only that.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
4

WEEK 1 · SHRINK IT
Break it into crumbs

Date _____

If a task still feels heavy, it's still too big. Breaking it into crumbs shows you the path and gives you lots of small wins along the way.

Try it today
Split your task into five tiny steps, each one taking ten minutes or less. Write them in the crumbs box. Start with crumb one.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

FIVE CRUMBS

- [ ] 1.
- [ ] 2.
- [ ] 3.
- [ ] 4.
- [ ] 5.

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
5

WEEK 1 · SHRINK IT
Lower the bar

Date _____

Perfectionism can quietly stop you starting. If the task has to be done brilliantly, it feels risky to begin. "Good enough" is much easier to start.

Try it today
Write down what a "good enough" version of your task looks like. Aim for that, not the perfect version. You can always improve it later.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

MY "GOOD ENOUGH" VERSION

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
6

WEEK 1 · SHRINK IT
Name the block

Date _____

Being stuck has a reason, even when it doesn't feel like it. Naming the reason tells you which tool to reach for. (See "What kind of stuck?" on page 5.)

Try it today
Before you start, ask: why is this one hard? Unclear? Boring? Too big? Scared to get it wrong? Too tired? Write it down, then choose a tool that fits.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
7

WEEK 1 · SHRINK IT
A gentle day

Date _____

Rest is part of the reset, not a break from it. Today, practise starting something small and kind, so your brain links "starting" with something good.

Try it today
Pick a comforting task: water the plants, make a proper lunch, have a shower, go for a short walk. Start it, notice how starting felt, and rest.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

WEEK 1 REVIEW

Looking back: Shrink it

Five minutes. No marks out of ten. This is just noticing.

DAYS I SHOWED UP (COLOUR THEM IN)

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

"Showing up" includes opening this book and deciding not today.

TOOLS THAT HELPED

TOOLS THAT DIDN'T CLICK

WINS THIS WEEK (ALL SIZES)

WHAT GOT IN THE WAY

NEXT WEEK, I WANT TO REMEMBER

WEEK 2 OF 4

Start it

Now the tasks are smaller, it's time for tools that get you over the starting line, especially on days when your brain just won't engage.

THIS WEEK'S TOOLS

- [ ] Day 8: Set the scene
- [ ] Day 9: The timer sprint
- [ ] Day 10: Body doubling
- [ ] Day 11: Make it ugly
- [ ] Day 12: Pair it
- [ ] Day 13: The countdown
- [ ] Day 14: Start in the middle

MY INTENTION FOR THIS WEEK

DAY
8

WEEK 2 · START IT
Set the scene

Date _____

Every bit of friction (finding things, clearing space, logging in) is another chance to get stuck. Setting things up ahead of time removes those barriers.

Try it today
Get everything ready for your task before you need it: open the document, put the form and pen on the table, lay out your gym kit. Then start.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
9

WEEK 2 · START IT

The timer sprint

Date _____

A short, clear time limit makes a task feel finite and adds a little urgency, which can help a sleepy brain wake up.

Try it today
Set a timer for ten minutes and work on your task until it rings. Then take a five-minute break. Do another sprint only if you want to.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
10

WEEK 2 · START IT
Body doubling

Date _____

Lots of people with ADHD find it easier to work with someone else around. They don't need to help, just be there.

Try it today
Do your task with someone nearby: a friend at the table, a video call, an online co-working room or a "study with me" video. Tell them what you're starting.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
11

WEEK 2 · START IT
Make it ugly

Date _____

Wanting it to be perfect from the start can stop you starting at all. A messy first version gives you something to work with.

Try it today
Do a deliberately rough version: a scruffy draft, a quick list, a messy first pass. Tell yourself it doesn't count, then do it.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
12

WEEK 2 · START IT
Pair it

Date _____

Boring tasks are hard to start because your brain isn't getting anything back. Pairing them with something you like changes the deal.

Try it today
Pair your task with something enjoyable: a podcast, a playlist, a nice drink, a favourite spot. You only get the treat while you're doing the task.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
13

WEEK 2 · START IT
The countdown

Date _____

Sometimes the gap between deciding and doing fills up with thinking. A countdown can cut that gap short.

Try it today
When you know what your first step is, count down out loud: 5, 4, 3, 2, 1. On "1", move your body: stand up, pick up the pen, open the tab.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
14

WEEK 2 · START IT
Start in the middle

Date _____

You don't have to start at the beginning. The first part is often the hardest, and starting anywhere builds momentum.

Try it today
Look at your crumbs and start with the easiest or most interesting one. Come back to the tricky bit once you're warmed up.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

WEEK 2 REVIEW

Looking back: Start it

Five minutes. No marks out of ten. This is just noticing.

DAYS I SHOWED UP (COLOUR THEM IN)

8 9 10 11 12 13 14

"Showing up" includes opening this book and deciding not today.

TOOLS THAT HELPED

TOOLS THAT DIDN'T CLICK

WINS THIS WEEK (ALL SIZES)

WHAT GOT IN THE WAY

NEXT WEEK, I WANT TO REMEMBER

WEEK 3 OF 4

Keep going

Starting is half the battle. This week is about keeping the momentum going and picking things back up when you drift.

THIS WEEK'S TOOLS

- [ ] Day 15: Make it visible
- [ ] Day 16: The done list
- [ ] Day 17: Add interest
- [ ] Day 18: The switch-over ritual
- [ ] Day 19: Leave a breadcrumb
- [ ] Day 20: Ask for help
- [ ] Day 21: Match your energy

MY INTENTION FOR THIS WEEK

DAY
15

WEEK 3 · KEEP GOING
Make it visible

Date _____

For many ADHD brains, out of sight really is out of mind. A task you can't see is easy to forget, or to quietly avoid.

Try it today
Put today's task somewhere you can't miss it: a sticky note on the kettle, a phone wallpaper, a note on the door. Then start.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
16

WEEK 3 · KEEP GOING
The done list

Date _____

To-do lists show only what's left. A done list shows what you've already managed, and seeing progress makes it easier to keep going.

Try it today
Every time you finish anything today, however small, add it to the done list below. Notice how long it gets by evening.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

DONE LIST

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
17

WEEK 3 · KEEP GOING
Add interest

Date _____

Many people with ADHD find it much easier to engage when something is new, interesting, challenging or urgent, and very hard when it isn't.

Try it today
Add one of those four to your task: make it a game, race a timer, try a new method or place, or set a small deadline with someone.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
18

WEEK 3 · KEEP GOING
The switch-over ritual

Date _____

Moving from one thing to another is a hard skill for lots of busy brains. A small ritual tells your brain "we're changing tracks now".

Try it today
Create a one-minute ritual for starting: stand up, stretch, refill your water, say "now I'm doing...". Use it before your task.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
19

WEEK 3 · KEEP GOING
Leave a breadcrumb

Date _____

Coming back to a half-finished task is hard if you can't remember where you were. A note to future you makes restarting much easier.

Try it today
When you stop today, write one sentence: "Next time, start by…". Leave it right on top of the task.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
20

WEEK 3 · KEEP GOING
Ask for help

Date _____

Some tasks stay stuck because we're trying to do them alone. Asking for help is a skill, not a failure.

Try it today
Choose one stuck task and ask someone to help with part of it: explain it, check it, sit with you, or do one piece. Write your message below.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

MY MESSAGE ASKING FOR HELP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
21

WEEK 3 · KEEP GOING
Match your energy

Date _____

Energy goes up and down. Asking a low-energy brain to do a high-energy task is a recipe for getting stuck.

Try it today
Rate your energy right now. Pick a task that matches it: easy admin on low days, bigger thinking tasks on high ones. Start that.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

WEEK 3 REVIEW

Looking back: Keep going

Five minutes. No marks out of ten. This is just noticing.

DAYS I SHOWED UP (COLOUR THEM IN)

15 16 17 18 19 20 21

"Showing up" includes opening this book and deciding not today.

TOOLS THAT HELPED

TOOLS THAT DIDN'T CLICK

WINS THIS WEEK (ALL SIZES)

WHAT GOT IN THE WAY

NEXT WEEK, I WANT TO REMEMBER

WEEK 4 OF 4

Make it yours

You've tried a lot of tools. This week you'll notice what works for your brain and build a plan you can keep using.

THIS WEEK'S TOOLS

- [ ] Day 22: Find your best time
- [ ] Day 23: If this, then that
- [ ] Day 24: Your reward menu
- [ ] Day 25: Kind self-talk
- [ ] Day 26: Reset your space
- [ ] Day 27: Tomorrow, tonight
- [ ] Day 28: Your unstuck toolkit

MY INTENTION FOR THIS WEEK

DAY
22

WEEK 4 · MAKE IT YOURS
Find your best time

Date _____

Most people have times of day when starting feels easier. Knowing yours means you can save the hard tasks for then.

Try it today
Notice when today you felt most able to start. Write it down. Over the week, look for a pattern, and plan tomorrow's hardest task for that time.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
23

WEEK 4 · MAKE IT YOURS
If this, then that

Date _____

Planning exactly when and where you'll start, as an "if-then" plan, can make you more likely to follow through.

Try it today
Write an if-then plan: "If it's 10am and I've had my coffee, then I'll open the email." Make it specific. Then let the plan do the deciding.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

MY IF-THEN PLAN

If _____

then I will _____

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
24

WEEK 4 · MAKE IT YOURS
Your reward menu

Date _____

Rewards that come straight after a task help your brain connect "doing" with "good feeling", especially for tasks with no instant payoff.

Try it today
Write a menu of small, quick rewards on page 47. Choose one for today's task and only have it when you've started (not finished).

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
25

WEEK 4 · MAKE IT YOURS
Kind self-talk

Date _____

When we're stuck, our inner voice can get harsh. Harsh words add shame, and shame makes starting even harder.

Try it today
Notice one unkind thought about yourself today. Write down what you'd say to a friend in the same spot. Say that to yourself instead.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

UNKIND THOUGHT → KIND VERSION

Unkind _____

Kind _____

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
26

WEEK 4 · MAKE IT YOURS
Reset your space

Date _____

A cluttered space can make it harder to focus. You don't need a perfect room, just one clear space to work in.

Try it today
Set a ten-minute timer and clear only the spot where you'll do your task. Then start the task while the space is fresh.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
27

WEEK 4 · MAKE IT YOURS
Tomorrow, tonight

Date _____

Mornings are full of decisions. Choosing tomorrow's one thing tonight means you wake up already knowing where to start.

Try it today
Before bed, write tomorrow's one thing and its first tiny step below. Set the scene for it if you can.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

TOMORROW'S ONE THING

Task _____

First tiny step _____

When _____

HOW DID IT GO?

- [ ] I finished it
- [ ] I started it
- [ ] I tried
- [ ] Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

DAY
28

WEEK 4 · MAKE IT YOURS
Your unstuck toolkit

Date _____

Over 28 days you've tried lots of tools. Some will have clicked and some won't, and that's exactly the point. You now know more about your brain.

Try it today
Look back through your pages and pick your three favourite tools. Write them on your Unstuck Plan (page 44). Start one task using one of them.

TODAY'S ONE THING

THE FIRST TINY STEP

HOW DID IT GO?

- ☐ I finished it
- ☐ I started it
- ☐ I tried
- ☐ Not today, and that's okay

ENERGY & MOOD

Energy ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Mood ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Stuck level ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

WHAT HELPED? WHAT GOT IN THE WAY?

WEEK 4 REVIEW

Looking back: Make it yours

Five minutes. No marks out of ten. This is just noticing.

DAYS I SHOWED UP (COLOUR THEM IN)

22 23 24 25 26 27 28

"Showing up" includes opening this book and deciding not today.

TOOLS THAT HELPED

TOOLS THAT DIDN'T CLICK

WINS THIS WEEK (ALL SIZES)

WHAT GOT IN THE WAY

NEXT WEEK, I WANT TO REMEMBER

KEEP IT

My Unstuck Plan

Everything you've learned, on one page. Stick it somewhere you'll see it.

MY TOP THREE TOOLS

- [ ] 1.
- [ ] 2.
- [ ] 3.

MY MOST COMMON KIND OF STUCK

MY BEST TIME FOR HARD TASKS

EARLY WARNING SIGNS I'M GETTING STUCK

MY GO-TO REWARDS

PEOPLE I CAN ASK FOR HELP OR BODY DOUBLING

WHAT I'LL SAY TO MYSELF

WHEN I'M REALLY STUCK, MY FIRST STEP IS

PRINT AS MANY AS YOU NEED

Task breakdown

Turn a big, scary task into crumbs. Each step should be a physical action that takes ten minutes or less.

The task _____

Why it matters to me _____

Good enough looks like _____

Kind of stuck _____ Due _____

#	TINY STEP (STARTS WITH A VERB)	TIME	DONE
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			

TOOL I'LL USE TO START

KEEP GOING

Brain dump

Get every task, worry and idea out of your head. Then circle just one to start with.

TODAY

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

THIS WEEK

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

SOMEDAY / MAYBE

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

KEEP GOING

Reward menu

Small, quick rewards for starting. Choose ones that are easy to get and don't take over the rest of your day.

FIVE MINUTES

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

FIFTEEN MINUTES

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

BIGGER WINS

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

IDEAS TO BORROW

A cup of tea in the good mug · one episode · a walk round the block · a favourite song (loud) · a snack · texting a friend · a chapter of a book · a sit in the sun · a puzzle · stretching · ten minutes of guilt-free scrolling · something new on the wishlist

REWARDS I'D LIKE TO SAVE UP FOR

KEEP GOING

Done list

Write down everything you've done, including the small things. Especially the small things.

DATE	WHAT I DID	HOW IT FELT

KEEP GOING

Body doubling log

Track who you work alongside and how it goes. Body doubling works best when you plan it in.

MY BODY DOUBLING OPTIONS

- [ ] A friend or family member nearby
- [ ] A video call with the camera on
- [ ] An online co-working room
- [ ] A "study with me" or "clean with me" video
- [ ] A café or library
- [ ]
- [ ]

DATE	WHO / WHERE	TASK	HOW LONG	HELPED?

28 DAYS

Your 28-day tracker

Colour in each day you open this book. Missed days aren't failures. They're just days.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28

THEN AND NOW: STARTING TASKS FEELS...

Day 1: _____

Day 28: _____

WHAT I'M PROUDEST OF

Well done

Whether you did every page or a handful, you've practised starting again and again, and that's the skill. Thank you for choosing Larkspur & Co. If this helped, a short Etsy review means the world to a small Glasgow business. More gentle planners at **larkspurco.uk**.

NOTES